

ASUS Jelly75 KD201

A colourful case for ditching the gamer aesthetic

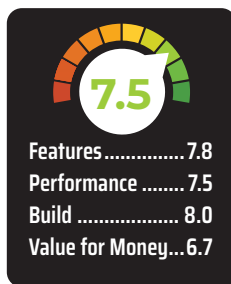
₹8,999



Before this, my entire mental model of an ASUS keyboard was built on a brief fling with an Azoth. Great board, wrong crowd for what I'm about to review. The Azoth is pure ROG: black-on-black styling, a chassis that could double as a projectile in a fight, RGB that insists on being noticed. Walk into the Jelly75 KD201 expecting more of that and you'll be confused within thirty seconds. This thing looks like someone raided a candy store and decided a keyboard could use some sugar too. And somehow, ASUS makes it work.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The Jelly75 has a clear housing and keycaps that look like they've been 3D-printed from gummy bears – round, tall, and slightly squishy-looking without being squishy. Its chassis allows you to get a view of the internals, which is one of the best things about a gasket-mount board. If your desk is now an all-white shrine to “gamer minimalism,” then the Jelly75 is going to be an act of rebellion. It rejects the entire ROG approach to things and embraces



its own style of life, and I mean that as a compliment. In terms of layout, it's a 75%, the same as my daily driver – the Aula F75 – which made the learning curve very fast. But where it falls flat is density. ASUS put more keys into less space than most 75% boards do, and the result is that the arrow keys are cramped alongside the Copilot key. I need arrow keys. I do not need Copilot. In fact, avoiding that exact key is the reason I still plug in an external keyboard with my laptop instead of using the one built in. Muscle memory betrayed me here more than once, and Copilot popped up on my screen enough times that I started to wonder if it was doing it on purpose.

UNBOXING AND VALUE

Once the box is opened, the excitement evaporates a bit. You will find a USB-A to Type-C cable, the 2.4GHz adapter and a sense of being cheated in some way. At a price of Rs. 8,999, not even one extra switch, and surprisingly, not even a hot-swap tool on a board that sells itself on the feature of hot swapping. Someone somewhere at ASUS

must have forgotten the very essence of hot-swappable ports, i.e., that there was something to be swapped in the first place.

CONNECTIVITY AND MULTITASKING

This is where the Jelly75 really earns its keep. Five computers with one keyboard: 2.4GHz, wired and three Bluetooth channels, each fully switchable with not a hitch. Visualize the traditional dual system: one Mac computer for office use and one Windows computer for playtime after work. Done with work? Flip the switch and switch from Bluetooth to wired or 2.4GHz before you even get to your mouse. There's even a special button on the keyboard that switches your entire keyboard into the correct operating system mode at the same time you switch the connection.

GAMING PERFORMANCE

Polling rate, for those new here, is essentially how many times per second the keyboard shares data with the computer on what button was just hit. In wired mode, the polling rate of the Jelly75 reaches 1000Hz, making it an absolute benchmark for competitive gaming. 2.4GHz polling rate, by comparison, reaches 500Hz, which is good enough. However, a Bluetooth connection will provide no more than 133Hz of polling rate, which seems perfectly fine but not when you are checking a corner in Valorant, and your inputs come in late. I have tested each of the polling modes in the course of several ranked matches, and Bluetooth is to be avoided the minute the stakes are raised.

TYPING EXPERIENCE

This is where the Jelly75 won me over. Look past its clear housing, and you'll find the gasket mount at work; there are little silicone bands holding up the plate such that it bends rather than hitting the enclosure head-on with every key press. Flexibility is the only thing separating boards which clatter like a hail storm from boards like this one. The Jelly75